QUICK GUIDE

HOT CUE MAP

What it is, how to spot it and what to do with it.

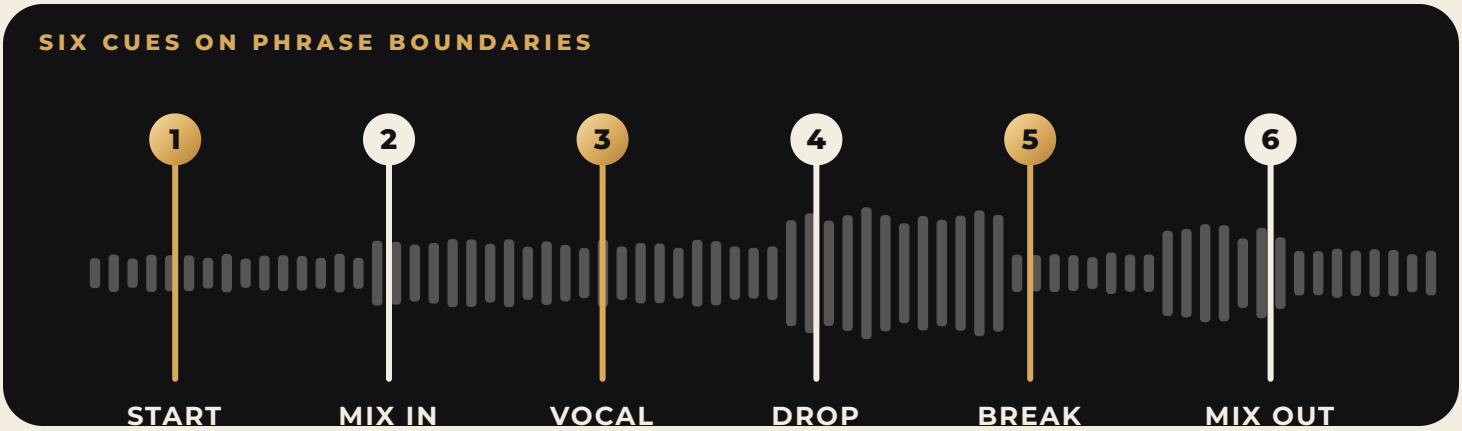
WHAT IT IS

A hot cue is a saved marker you can jump to with one pad. A cue map is a consistent layout of markers, so you always know what each pad does.

WHAT YOU'LL NOTICE

Fast and confident. You go straight to the part of the track you need.

SIX CUES ON PHRASE BOUNDARIES



01

MARK THE MOVES

Start, mix in, vocal, drop, break and mix out cover most tracks.

02

CHECK THE GRID FIRST

A cue on a bad grid jumps late or early every time.

03

SAME LAYOUT EVERY TRACK

Same pad, same job, same color. Your hands learn it.

DO THIS TONIGHT

Set four cues on five tracks, then mix using only cue jumps.

- [ ] Fix the beatgrid before you place any cue.
- [ ] Set intro, break, drop and outro on phrase boundaries.
- [ ] Mix between two tracks using only your cue pads.



PRACTICE & CHECK

HOT CUE MAP: YOUR TURN

WHERE YOU'LL MEET IT AS A DJ

- Starting a track on its first beat or its vocal.
- Jumping to the drop after a breakdown.
- Jumping back to repeat a moment for the crowd.

QUICK CHECK

1. What should you check before placing cues?

2. Why use the same layout on every track?

3. Should every pad be filled?

Answer key: 1) The beatgrid. 2) Your hands learn what each pad does. 3) No. Some tracks only need two or three cues.

REMEMBER

Same pad. Same job. Every track.

YOUR NOTES

UP NEXT Loops as a Safety Net

